

Build with AI: Multimodal Prompting

How to use images, audio and text together to get way better AI results



Hi, I'm Kainat!

Today we learn how to use **multiple formats** in one prompt and unlock a whole new level of AI power.

Text + Image

Text + Audio

All Together

Used by 500+ students

Swipe to learn all 3 steps Scroll through all 12 slides!

What is Multimodal Prompting?



Think of it like painting. You **can** use one color. But why would you, when you have the whole palette?

SIMPLE DEFINITION

Multimodal = using **multiple formats** (text, image, audio) in the same prompt. The AI processes them all together to give you a richer, smarter answer.



Text

Instructions, questions, context



Image

Photos, diagrams, screenshots



Audio

Voice notes, recordings, sounds

3x

more useful answers when you add
an image or audio to your prompt



Text-only prompts give generic, surface-level answers



Multimodal prompts give specific, context-rich answers

The world is multimodal. Your prompts should be too.

Before AI vs After AI

Your Task	Text Only	Multimodal
Write a poem about a sunset	Generic, vague lines	Specific colors from your photo
Get recipe ideas	Random ingredients suggested	Recipes from YOUR fridge photo
Describe an atmosphere	Generic scene setting	Based on audio you recorded
Design a brand teaser	Generic color suggestions	Uses your actual brand logos

Which column are you living in right now?

Define Your Task and Modalities

Tell AI **exactly** what you need and **why** you're including each file. Don't just attach it and hope for the best.

COPY-PASTE PROMPT

Here is a photo of **[your subject]**.
I want you to **[task]** based on
what you see in this image.
Focus specifically on **[detail to highlight]**
and ignore **[anything to exclude]**.



Be specific

Say which part of the image or audio to focus on



State the why

Tell AI why you included this media file



Set limits

Exclude parts you don't want AI to use

Best tools for this step:

ChatGPT

Claude

Gemini

Perplexity

Add Context and References

Context works the same way in multimodal. But now you also choose **which parts of your media** matter most.

COPY-PASTE PROMPT

I am a **[your role]** working on **[your project]**.
Only consider the **[specific part]**
in this image. Ignore the background.
Use this audio to inspire the **[tone/mood]**.



Visual Reference

Upload brand logos, mood boards, or product photos



Audio Reference

Share a voice note or ambient recording for tone



Text Context

Add constraints, goals, and what to skip

Not every tool supports every format. Check before you upload!

Evaluate and Iterate

Multimodal outputs need **extra review**. A visual output has more ways to go wrong than plain text.

1 Run the prompt and review carefully
Check if AI actually used your image or audio, not just your text

2 Look for missed details
Did AI ignore a specific part of the image you needed?

3 Iterate using one of four methods
Don't start over. Refine what you already have.

 Revisit the framework

 Break into shorter tasks

 Add constraints

 Tweak your phrasing

One good iteration beats starting from scratch every time.

Text Only vs Multimodal Prompt

Text Only Prompt

- ✗ Gives surface-level answers
- ✗ No context about your real situation
- ✗ Generic suggestions every time
- ✗ You describe everything in words
- ✗ Misses visual or audio nuance

VS

Multimodal Prompt

- ✓ Deep, specific, accurate answers
- ✓ AI sees what you actually have
- ✓ Personalized to your exact input
- ✓ Show, don't tell. Upload the file.
- ✓ Captures detail text can't describe

Works on: ChatGPT | Claude | Gemini | Perplexity
Same question. Completely different quality of answer.

Which AI Tool for Which Modality?

Pick the right tool for your media type



ChatGPT

Great for image analysis, document reading and long-context tasks

Images

Documents

Text



Claude

Best for detailed document analysis, image understanding and nuanced writing

Images

Documents

Text



Gemini

Strong with images, video context and Google Workspace integration

Images

Audio

Text



Perplexity

Best for research with image + real-time web context combined

Images

Search

Your 3-Step Cheat Sheet

1

Define Task and Modality

Tell AI what you want and **why you're uploading** each file. Be specific about which part to use.

2

Add Context and References

Share your role, constraints, and any **visual or audio references**. Tell AI what to ignore too.

3

Evaluate and Iterate

Check if the output used your media properly. Refine using **one of four iteration methods**.

Know the limits

- ⚠️ AI can struggle with abstract ideas in images
- ⚠️ Counting objects in images is not reliable yet
- ⚠️ Not every tool supports every modality

Pro tip: Combine all three modalities for the most powerful results!

LAB TIME! Your First Multimodal Prompt

1 Take a photo of something around you right now

2 Open any AI tool that supports image upload ([ChatGPT](#), [Claude](#) or [Gemini](#))

3 Upload your photo and paste this prompt:

COPY-PASTE PROMPT

Here is a photo of **[what you photographed]**.
Describe what you see and suggest
3 creative ways I could use or
improve this for **[your goal]**.
Focus only on **[specific detail]**.

4 Compare the result with a text-only version of the same question

5 Share what surprised you in the comments below!

Share your multimodal result in the comments!

One Question For You

Which modality are you most excited to try first?

A Image prompting for design or recipe ideas

B Audio prompting for creative writing or storytelling

C Mixing all formats together for one big prompt

Comment A, B, or C below!

Or comment MULTI to get my multimodal prompt starter pack.

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